

here is our treat to all our procrastinating brethren out there, we present to you our view (and guide) to how life should be.

We want that we should have to do as little as possible to get by. But, that should not take any of our luxury away from us. Making other people do it for us would be just mean. So why not make stuff do itself? Why not have all the tasks that you have to do on a device, be done by the device itself? We want that none of our slaves (read: equipment/devices) should get a moment's peace. They should work through the day, and then continue to do so for the night, so that we don't have to worry about them, day or night. We want that none of the tasks that you have to do are tedious, and that you aren't bored by whatever little that you have to do – mainly because you are pumped by the power that you have in your hands with making so much of machinery work for your end. Before our wishlist spins out of control and you start wondering if you've wasted time reading this, we must give you a sneak-peak into our vision for the future. And that future is not a distant one but much of it you can attain just by reading the next couple of pages. So, picture this...

"You wake up to the sound of an alarm, which was set up in your phone last night, but it's not the phone ring that wakes you, the sound comes from your iPod Dock. The phone conveyed, at the desired moment, the signal to the dock to ring the alarm. Your 'all-purpose' tablet is already loaded with your tasks to do today, along with your favourite newspaper reader app already opened. Read it if you want, or if you're too sleepy to do that, it can read news out to you – just say the word. Really, just say the word, and your digital assistant springs into action. These days, it's just one iteration of a personal assistant, who's there for you, the same on every device. It knows all of your interactions with all of your devices, and is equipped with not just command-following skills, but also cognitive ability, i.e., it can now understand you and do some repetitive tasks by itself. While the news is being read to you, somewhere along the way, a signal is sent to the coffee machine to prepare a steaming cup for you, by the time you get to the kitchen. We

all dream of having some background score to our lives, and now it is a reality. The sensors in your tablet or wearable sensors will judge your mood once you wake up from bed, and play music from some radio streaming service accordingly. Well this last bit was a vision of the future once it catches up but what about simple things on your devices that can be automated right now?



Let your machines do the grunt work

The wallpapers on all of your computer devices are altered as per the forecasted weather for the day, giving you an idea of what to expect. Simple Rainmeter (with some scripts) has picked up cloudy wallpapers and is silently cycling through them. When you reach your computer, you find that all of your requested files from last day have been downloaded and arranged properly in the organised haven that is your computer. All of your previous files have been backed up, both to a local drive and to the cloud. You get up to bathe, and get ready, to find your car ready and waiting for you. The streaming of the music continues, because the machines recognise your location and presence. As you drive out, thanks to new technologies such as {on X} your phone is already in the

GPS profile – landscape orientation, mapping application on, ready to be docked. It's already charted the best route as per the known traffic info. When you reach office, automation apps in your phone have already recognised the familiar tower and gone into the Work Profile. At your computer desk things software such as Evernote and Catch have synced the to-do list that you jotted down on your tablet while having breakfast. Your tasks for the day have been laid out on your computer's screen. All your required applications are ready for your use, every step of the way, and anything that is out of order can be corrected by simple conversations with the system.

Any new developments that require your attention will be sent to you directly, by analysing your location – to your computer if you're there, or to your Pebble watch, which is also in on the action. Finish your day, and set your target location in your car – your pub, or a friend's place, or don't say anything and the car will take you home. Have your meal, and lay down, relax. Your preferred tracks are playing again, if you want them to. If you suddenly remember something important, sync it to your 'to-do list', and it's added to your tasks for tomorrow (or whenever else you want it to be). Relax with your favourite movie or TV show, which your computer downloaded for you while you were away. Satisfied with yourself and your world, you go to sleep. Then you wake up again..."

This has been a dream in the pipeline for many years, because apparently we are not the only 'workophobics' out there. And cheers to those people, for they have brought this pipeline dream very, very close to reality. Enough with the drumroll, we should now get started with the details of what exactly we're talking about here. For remember, if you want to save hours of your time sorting, copying, converting, downloading and doing so many mundane tasks, you need to spend some of it to actually set the ball rolling. The workshops in the following pages will require time no doubt to implement, but only once. So go ahead, we want you to experience what we've just described here. Go forth, young 'un, spoil yourself...

REASON
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